

SDGs Alignment of Indonesia’s Research Strength

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Indonesia has built **62 SDG Centers** in a decade. Whether they are pointed at the right problems depends on two things the study had to measure separately: what universities are strong at, and what provinces actually need. This section sets out how each side was measured, before turning to what the numbers show.

Contents

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How the study was done

Four strands of evidence, two bibliometric sources, and two different definitions of demand

II

What the numbers show

The growth of the SDG Center network, and the priorities provinces state for themselves

I How the study was done

Supply and demand are measured from entirely different sources — bibliometric databases on one side, planning documents and official indicators on the other. The gap analysis only makes sense once both are expressed as a ranking over the same 16 goals.

THE EVIDENCE BASE

A mixed-methods study, with the quantitative work resting on four data sources

THE EVIDENCE BASE

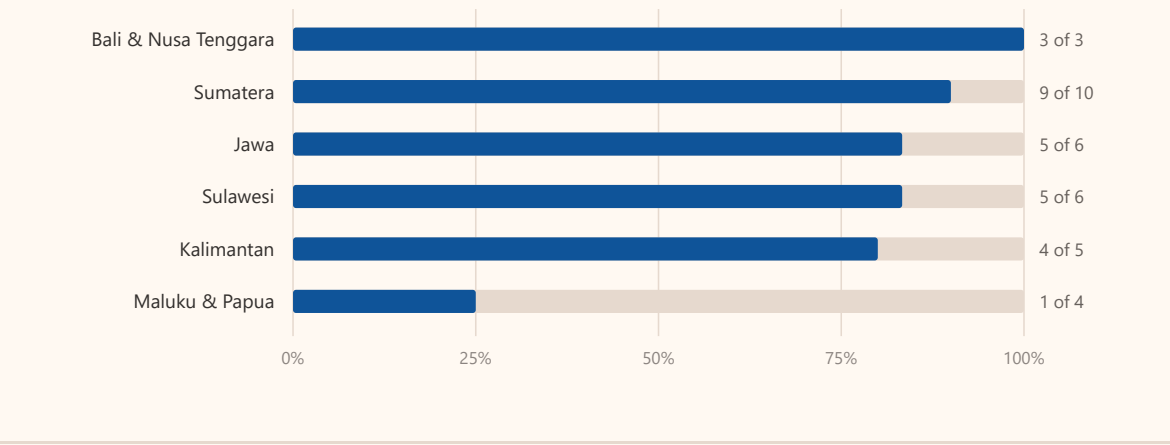
Four strands

1	Desk study	RPJMD content analysis for all 34 provinces, bibliometrics from SciVal and Scopus, and a literature review on multidisciplinary research centres.
2	Surveys	Provincial Bappeda on SDG implementation and needs; SDG Centers on their institutional arrangements.
3	FGDs	Local governments, universities and operating SDG Centers, plus the ministry, to align programmes with the university resource map.
4	Quantitative	The Bappenas SDG Dashboard, used to align provincial progress with university research strengths.

SURVEY COVERAGE

27 of 34 provinces responded

Fieldwork ran 25 February to 14 March 2025. Coverage is strong everywhere except the east.



SUPPLY

Two bibliometric layers, merged

Research strength is measured at the university, then attributed to the province the university sits in.

1	SciVal — quality	181 Indonesian institutions listed; 21 excluded as non-higher-education, leaving 160 universities . Metric: citation count per SDG.
2	Scopus — quantity	578 Indonesian organisations, of which 457 are universities . Metric: number of documents contributing to each SDG.
3	Concordance	455 Scopus institution names matched semi-manually against the 160 SciVal names, because naming varies across Indonesian and English forms and abbreviation styles.

TWO DEFINITIONS

Demand is measured twice, and the two measures do not have to agree

DEMAND, FIRST DEFINITION

What provinces say they want

Content analysis of the medium-term development plan (RPJMD) of all 34 provinces.

1	Extract	Vision, mission, goals and priority programmes from each province's RPJMD.
2	Map to SDGs	Manual review by the research team, then ChatGPT as a comparative tool, then verification by senior researchers.
3	Rank	Goals ordered by prominence; the highest priority is rank 1.

DEMAND, SECOND DEFINITION

Where provinces are actually falling short

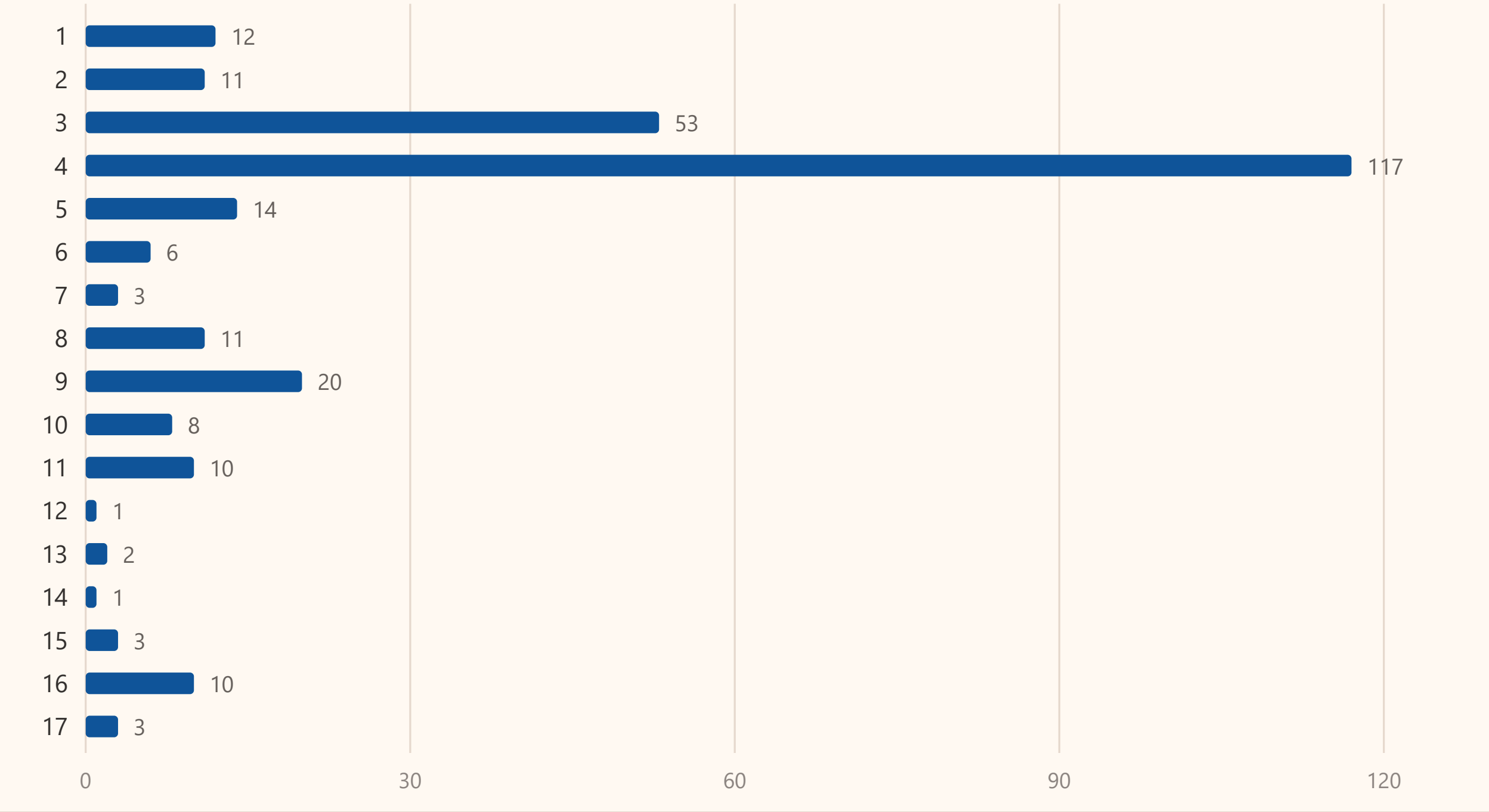
An achievement index built from the National SDGs Secretariat's indicator set.

1	Normalise	Each of 285 indicator-dimensions rescaled 0–1 against official thresholds, or empirical bounds (± 2 SD) where no standard exists, with direction set by whether higher or lower is better.
2	Aggregate	Principal component analysis within each goal, producing a 0–100 achievement index per goal per province.
3	Rank	Goals 1–16 ordered by index; the <i>lowest</i> score is rank 1, the goal most in need of support.

WHAT THE ACHIEVEMENT INDEX RESTS ON

The indicator base is very uneven across goals

Number of indicator-dimensions available per SDG in the provincial dataset. Goal 4 has 117; Goals 12 and 14 have one each.



PUTTING THE TWO SIDES TOGETHER

From supply and demand to a gap

Two tests, both run province by province and for Indonesia as a whole.

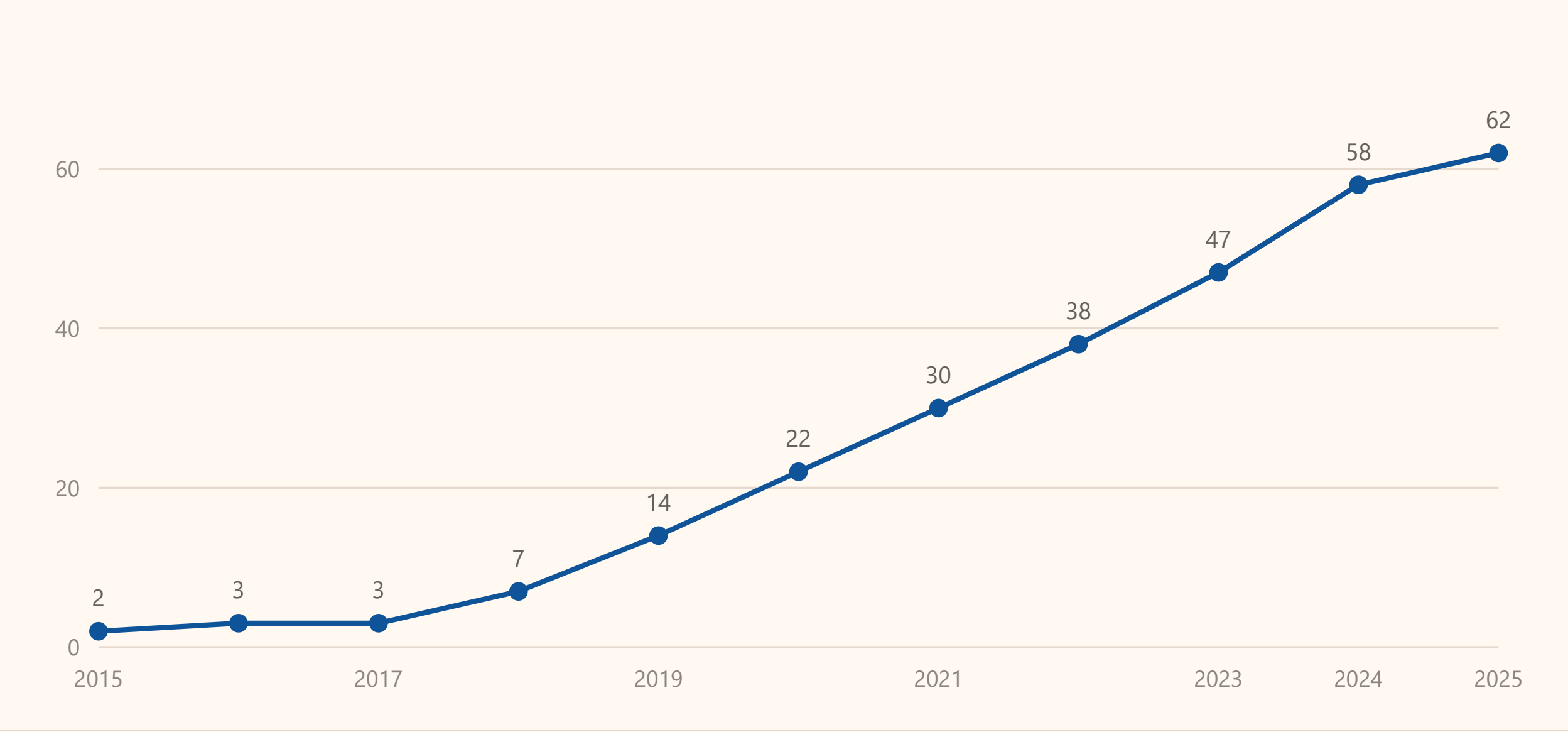
1	Spearman rank correlation	Correlates the ranking of SDGs by university output against the ranking of SDGs by achievement. Because rank 1 means ‘most published’ on one side and ‘worst performing’ on the other, a positive coefficient means research is concentrated where the province is weakest.
2	Top-5 matching	Counts how many goals appear in both a province's five strongest SDGs by publication and its five weakest by achievement.

II What the numbers show

Two figures from the report: how fast the SDG Center network was built, and what provincial governments say they are trying to achieve.

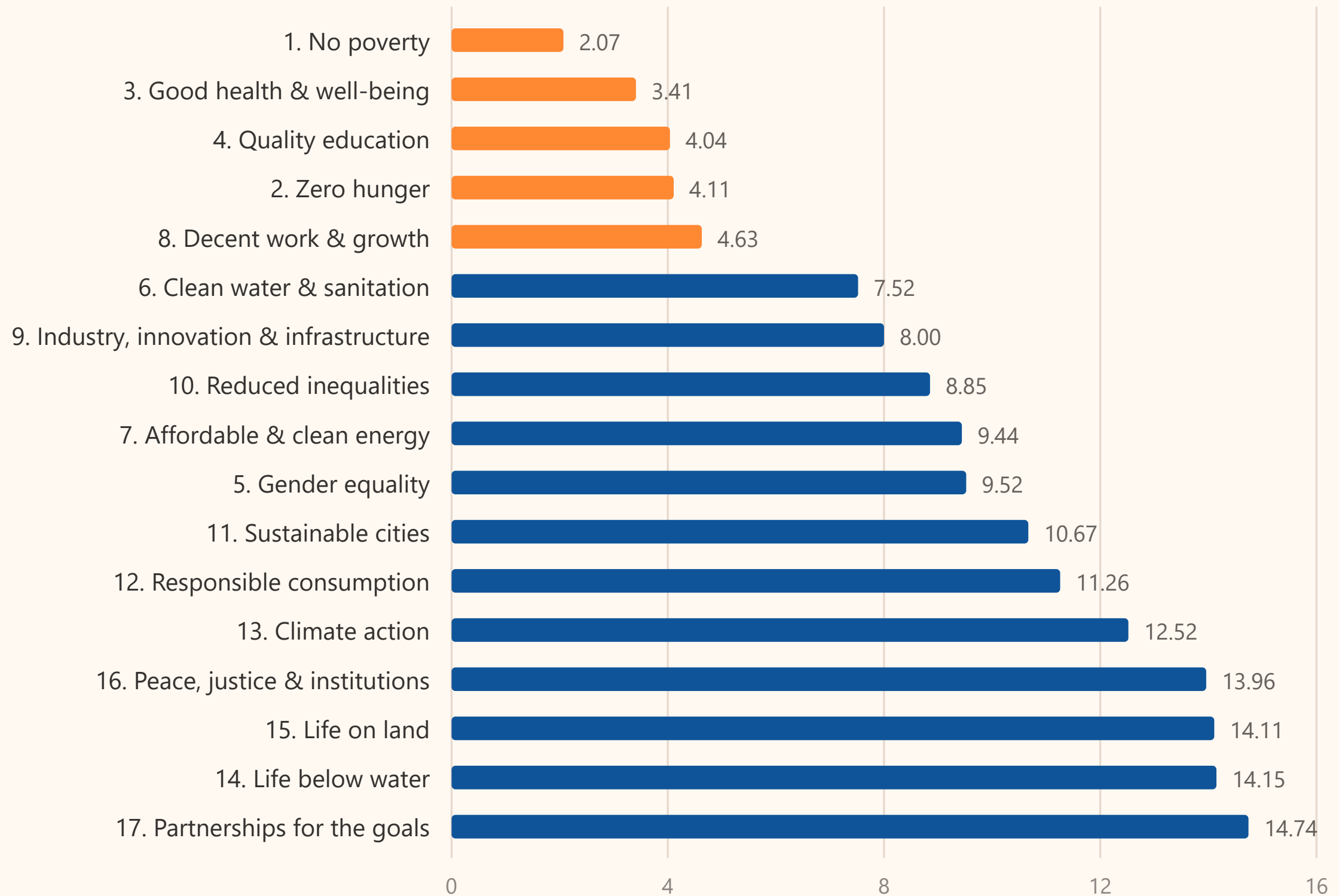
SDG Centers went from 2 to 62 in a decade

Cumulative number of SDG Centers established in Indonesia, 2015–2025.



What provinces say they prioritise

Mean priority rank across responding provinces. A *lower* value means a higher priority; the five highest-priority goals are highlighted.



Source. All content is drawn from the *SDG Center Business Model — Final Report (2025)*, prepared for the Asian Development Bank. Method described in §2 (Research Methodology) and §4 (Findings and Analysis); figures redrawn from the report's Figure 3-2 and Figure 4-1, with Table 2-2 and Table 4-18 shown as charts. Where a figure is redrawn rather than reproduced, the underlying values are the report's own.